Online Appendix (Supplementary Online Material (SOM))

Monday 9th November, 2026 12:23

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1 more refined results

1.1 taking into account age bracket and age when having a child

A key variable to explore is age and age when having a child. Parents tend to be much older at 45 v non-parents at 28 in this sample. Then without taking age into account, results could be attributed not to having a child, but to age and other developments that go with it notably much higher income. Hence we pay extra attention to age here.

First we look at distribution–histogram is in figure **??**. A very different distributions emerge–non-parents are mostly around 20 then sharply decreasing to 40 where it levels off at small level. Parents are quite normally distributed with mean and median around 45. Then we create 5 quantiles.

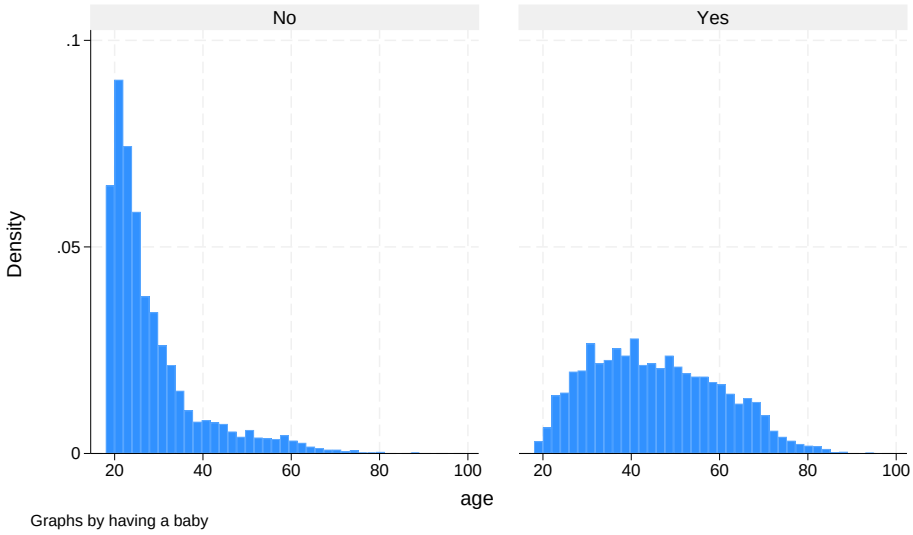


Figure 1: Histogram of age by parenthood.

```
. ta edad qAge
```

age	5 quantiles of edad 1	2	3	4	5	Total
18	108	0	0	0	0	108
19	269	0	0	0	0	269
20	233	0	0	0	0	233
21	309	0	0	0	0	309
22	263	0	0	0	0	263
23	249	0	0	0	0	249
24	0	226	0	0	0	226
25	0	204	0	0	0	204
26	0	174	0	0	0	174
27	0	182	0	0	0	182
28	0	176	0	0	0	176
29	0	162	0	0	0	162
30	0	162	0	0	0	162
31	0	0	180	0	0	180
32	0	0	156	0	0	156
33	0	0	125	0	0	125
34	0	0	131	0	0	131
35	0	0	121	0	0	121
36	0	0	134	0	0	134
37	0	0	113	0	0	113
38	0	0	113	0	0	113
39	0	0	106	0	0	106
40	0	0	120	0	0	120
41	0	0	0	132	0	132
42	0	0	0	112	0	112
43	0	0	0	89	0	89
44	0	0	0	104	0	104
45	0	0	0	99	0	99
46	0	0	0	88	0	88
47	0	0	0	95	0	95
48	0	0	0	85	0	85
49	0	0	0	114	0	114
50	0	0	0	90	0	90
51	0	0	0	98	0	98
52	0	0	0	91	0	91
53	0	0	0	75	0	75
54	0	0	0	0	79	79
55	0	0	0	0	80	80
56	0	0	0	0	86	86
57	0	0	0	0	72	72
58	0	0	0	0	82	82
59	0	0	0	0	71	71
60	0	0	0	0	73	73
61	0	0	0	0	69	69
62	0	0	0	0	65	65
63	0	0	0	0	57	57
64	0	0	0	0	57	57
65	0	0	0	0	42	42
66	0	0	0	0	55	55
67	0	0	0	0	52	52
68	0	0	0	0	44	44
69	0	0	0	0	54	54
70	0	0	0	0	39	39
71	0	0	0	0	35	35
72	0	0	0	0	20	20
73	0	0	0	0	24	24
74	0	0	0	0	22	22
75	0	0	0	0	12	12
76	0	0	0	0	9	9
77	0	0	0	0	15	15
78	0	0	0	0	11	11

79	0	0	0	0	7	7
80	0	0	0	0	12	12
81	0	0	0	0	4	4
82	0	0	0	0	9	9
83	0	0	0	0	4	4
84	0	0	0	0	3	3
85	0	0	0	0	5	5
86	0	0	0	0	1	1
87	0	0	0	0	1	1
88	0	0	0	0	2	2
89	0	0	0	0	2	2
93	0	0	0	0	1	1
Total	1,431	1,286	1,299	1,272	1,276	6,564

Finally we turn to the quantities of interest: life satisfaction by parenthood and 5 age quantiles in table below. Note there are good cell sizes at $>$100.

A perhaps surprising news is that its similar for all age grps same pattern–so after all age group does not matter that much for life satisfaction difference between parents and non-parents. Still, there are note-worthy differences: For first 3 quantiles the parent premium is about .1, in 4th it goes up to .15, and in 5th it further increases to about .20. So in short premium of being a parent goes up with age of the parent.

Note this table is also in the body of the ms.

	5 quantiles of age					
	1	2	3	4	5	Total
parent						
No	8.14	8.17	8.34	8.24	8.10	8.18
Yes	8.25	8.26	8.46	8.39	8.29	8.35
Total	8.15	8.20	8.42	8.36	8.27	8.28

Another relevant factor is age of a child–it is very different to have a baby, adolescent and grown up. Keep in mind it is the first child. In table below we tabulate mean life satisfaction by 5 quantiles of child age. Probably as expected having babies in 1st quantile does not yield much happiness. There is .07 increase for adolescents in 2nd quantile; and then gradual drop throught quantile 5, and that is arguably due to aging of a parent. We explore it further in the next table.

```
. table qBabyAge , stat(mean satisfac) nformat(%9.2f)
```

	Mean
5 quantiles of babyAge	
1	8.37
2	8.45
3	8.34
4	8.31
5	8.27
Total	8.35

In table below we show tabulations of mean life satisfaction by parent v non-parent in columns and by 5 quantiles of respondent's age in rows. There is an inverted U-shape for both parents and non-parents with maximum in the middle 3rd quantile. And consistently in all age brackets parents are happier than non-parents by about .1. and the biggest difference being for the oldest parents v oldest non-parents. Thus an interesting finidng is that life satisfaction premium of having a child is greatest in parent's old age, probably as expected .

Note this table is also in the body of the ms.

```
table qAge baby, stat(mean satisfac) nformat(%9.2f)
```

	parent		
	No	Yes	Total
5 quantiles of age			
1	8.14	8.25	8.15
2	8.17	8.26	8.20
3	8.34	8.46	8.42
4	8.24	8.39	8.36
5	8.10	8.29	8.27
Total	8.18	8.35	8.28

2 initial results

Table 1: Variable definitions.

name	description
life satisfaction	"In general, how satisfied are you with all aspects of your life?"
having a baby	"Do you have children?"
female	female
age	age
health condition	"Would you say that, in general, your health is"
socio-economic strata	"What is the socio-economic strata of your home?"
household size	household size
standard	"Are you satisfied with your standard of living? That is, with all the things you can buy and do"
education	primary, secondary, technical, professional, postgraduate, or none
marital status	"What is your marital status?"
income	"How much on average income?"
poor	"Could you tell me if you consider yourself financially poor?"
relationship satisfaction	"How satisfied are you with the following aspects of your life?" relationship

2.1 paper regressions

Table 2: OLS regressions of `life satisfaction`.

	a1	a2	a3	a4	a5	a5a	a6
having a baby	0.16***	0.14*	0.15**	0.17**	0.02	0.10	0.10+
female		-0.07+	-0.03	0.04	-0.00	-0.00	0.05
age		0.01	0.01	0.01	-0.00	0.00	0.01
age squared		-0.00	-0.00	-0.00	0.00	-0.00	-0.00
household size		0.01	0.03**	0.03**	0.04+	0.05+	0.03**
income			0.08***	0.08***	0.01	0.02	0.06**
poor			-0.67***	-0.62***	-0.66***	-0.70***	-0.53***
standard			0.93***	0.90***	0.87***	0.88***	0.78***
socio-economic strata			-0.00	-0.01	0.07*	0.07*	-0.01
education				-0.03	-0.06	-0.07+	-0.04+
health condition				0.23***	0.19***	0.19***	0.20***
marital status:							
married/free union					0.24**		
separated/widowed					0.03		
relationship satisfaction							0.13***
constant	8.36***	8.10***	7.27***	6.51***	6.92***	6.84***	5.94***
N	6568	6520	6233	6134	2294	2294	6107

+ 0.10 * 0.05 ** 0.01 *** 0.001

Table 3: OLS regressions of `life satisfaction`.regBB1

	a4	b1	b2	b3
having a baby	0.166**			
female	0.041	0.068		
age	0.013	0.004	0.009	0.003
age squared	-0.000	-0.000	-0.000	-0.000
household size	0.031**	0.029**	0.026**	0.029**
income	0.077***			
poor	-			
	0.616***			
standard	0.895***			
education	-0.032	0.007	0.033	0.006
health condition	0.234***	0.290***	0.303***	0.289***
socio-economic strata	-0.006	0.054**	0.067***	0.054**
No		0.000	0.000	
Yes		0.047	0.302***	
none or lt min wage		0.000		
gt min wage		0.181**		
No × none or lt min wage		0.000		0.000
No × gt min wage		0.000		0.303**
Yes × none or lt min wage		0.000		-0.130
Yes × gt min wage		0.206*		0.646***
male			0.000	
female			0.109+	
No × male			0.000	
No × female			0.000	
Yes × male			0.000	
Yes × female			-0.156+	
male × none or lt min wage				0.000
male × gt min wage				-0.114
female × none or lt min wage				0.121
female × gt min wage				0.000
No × male × none or lt min wage				0.000
No × male × gt min wage				0.000
No × female × none or lt min wage				0.000
No × female × gt min wage				0.000
Yes × male × none or lt min wage				0.000
Yes × male × gt min wage				0.000
Yes × female × none or lt min wage				0.236
Yes × female × gt min wage				-0.208*
constant	6.510***	6.768***	6.625***	6.749***
N	6134	6298	6404	6298
+ 0.10 * 0.05 ** 0.01 *** 0.001				

Table 4: OLS regressions of `life satisfaction`.

	c1	c2	c3	c3a	c3b	c3c	c4	c5
baby born:								
11-19	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00
20-24	0.07	0.08	0.03	0.04	0.08	0.03	0.04	-0.01
25-29	0.18*	0.17*	0.04	0.11	0.10	0.08	0.01	0.02
30-34	0.25*	0.24*	0.08	0.10	0.14	0.12	-0.01	0.01
35-54	0.03	0.03	-0.13	-0.13	-0.07	-0.10	-0.25	-0.27
female		-0.13*	-0.02	-0.11+	-0.06	-0.13*	-0.01	0.03
age		0.01	0.01	0.01	0.02	0.01	0.01	0.00
age squared		-0.00	-0.00	-0.00	-0.00	-0.00	-0.00	-0.00
household size		0.01	0.02	0.01	0.02	0.02	0.02	0.00
income			0.26***				0.13***	0.08
poor				-1.00***			-0.67***	-0.67***
standard					1.15***		0.96***	0.95***
socio-economic strata						0.14***	-0.01	0.09*
education								-0.12*
health condition								0.13**
marital status:								
married/free union								0.28*
separated/widowed								0.16
constant	8.34***	8.23***	7.74***	8.51***	7.24***	7.97***	7.34***	7.03***
N	3774	3752	3696	3685	3711	3742	3589	1303

+ 0.10 * 0.05 ** 0.01 *** 0.001

Table 5: OLS regressions of `life satisfaction`.

	d1	d2	d3	d4	d5	d5a	d6
RECODE of P05000202 (Cantidad de hijos)=1	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00
RECODE of P05000202 (Cantidad de hijos)=2	-0.05	-0.05	-0.06	-0.05	-0.16	-0.12	-0.06
RECODE of P05000202 (Cantidad de hijos)=3	0.06	0.07	0.19*	0.19*	0.09	0.12	0.19*
RECODE of P05000202 (Cantidad de hijos)=4	-0.09	-0.09	0.15	0.15	-0.16	-0.12	0.08
RECODE of P05000202 (Cantidad de hijos)=5	-0.15	-0.14	0.10	0.08	0.33	0.33	0.12
female		-0.16**	-0.01	0.05	0.05	0.04	0.11+
age		0.01	0.01	0.01	0.01	0.01	0.00
age squared		-0.00	-0.00	-0.00	-0.00	-0.00	-0.00
household size		0.01	0.02	0.03	0.00	0.00	0.02
income			0.12***	0.11**	0.09	0.09	0.09**
poor			-0.68***	-0.62***	-0.68***	-0.74***	-0.53***
standard			0.96***	0.92***	0.95***	0.96***	0.79***
socio-economic strata			0.00	0.00	0.09*	0.09*	-0.00
education				-0.04	-0.11*	-0.11*	-0.05
health condition				0.21***	0.13**	0.13**	0.19***
marital status:							
married/free union					0.31**		
separated/widowed					0.16		
relationship satisfaction							0.13***
constant	8.45***	8.24***	7.39***	6.72***	6.94***	7.01***	6.11***
N	3793	3770	3607	3542	1307	1307	3524

+ 0.10 * 0.05 ** 0.01 *** 0.001

2.2 $< 2024 - 04 - 24Wed >$ babies age

First generated couple categories to dummy it out (note: not quintiles; rather teens, early 20s, etc).

```
. ta  babyBorn qbabyBorn
```

Age at which first child was born	5 quantiles of babyBorn					Total
	1	2	3	4	5	
11	1	0	0	0	0	1
12	4	0	0	0	0	4
13	12	0	0	0	0	12
14	35	0	0	0	0	35
15	114	0	0	0	0	114
16	167	0	0	0	0	167
17	243	0	0	0	0	243
18	278	0	0	0	0	278
19	313	0	0	0	0	313
20	0	384	0	0	0	384
21	0	257	0	0	0	257
22	0	231	0	0	0	231
23	0	224	0	0	0	224
23.5	0	1	0	0	0	1
24	0	189	0	0	0	189
25	0	0	269	0	0	269
26	0	0	133	0	0	133
27	0	0	133	0	0	133
28	0	0	136	0	0	136
29	0	0	73	0	0	73
30	0	0	0	187	0	187
31	0	0	0	49	0	49
32	0	0	0	52	0	52
33	0	0	0	57	0	57
34	0	0	0	38	0	38
35	0	0	0	0	47	47
36	0	0	0	0	24	24
37	0	0	0	0	25	25
38	0	0	0	0	21	21
39	0	0	0	0	11	11
40	0	0	0	0	27	27
41	0	0	0	0	3	3
42	0	0	0	0	9	9
43	0	0	0	0	3	3
44	0	0	0	0	5	5
45	0	0	0	0	8	8
46	0	0	0	0	3	3
47	0	0	0	0	3	3
48	0	0	0	0	3	3
49	0	0	0	0	1	1
50	0	0	0	0	3	3
54	0	0	0	0	2	2
Total	1,167	1,286	744	383	198	3,778

Then regressions in table 6. C1 and c2: best to have babies in 20s or early 30s. Health and age in c3 really weakens the relationship and income in c4 kills it alltogether. So then we explore interactions with income.

Table 6: OLS regressions of `life satisfaction`.

	c1	c2	c3	c4
5 quantiles of babyBorn=1	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00
5 quantiles of babyBorn=2	0.07	0.06	-0.01	-0.05
5 quantiles of babyBorn=3	0.18*	0.15+	0.10	-0.01
5 quantiles of babyBorn=4	0.25*	0.21*	0.18+	0.05
5 quantiles of babyBorn=5	0.03	-0.03	-0.04	-0.17
female		-0.11+	-0.04	0.04
age			0.00	0.00
age squared			-0.00	-0.00
Health condition			0.31***	0.27***
no income				0.00
lt 1 SMMLV				-0.02
1-2 SMMLV				0.33*
2-4 SMMLV				0.54***
4-8 SMMLV				0.64***
gt 8 SMMLV				0.91***
constant	8.34***	8.42***	7.25***	7.12***
N	3774	3763	3733	3677
+ 0.10 * 0.05 ** 0.01 *** 0.001				

I generate a dummy for good income: 1 if income>1SMMLV

recode promedioingresos (0 1 =0)(2 3 4 5=1),gen(incGood)

and interact it in figure 2. The intersting result, and probably expected, is that as respondents get older income matters more for happiness from babies, especially in category 4, early 30s, for last category, late 30s and 40s there is little difference between rich and poor just as is the case in category 1, the teenagers.

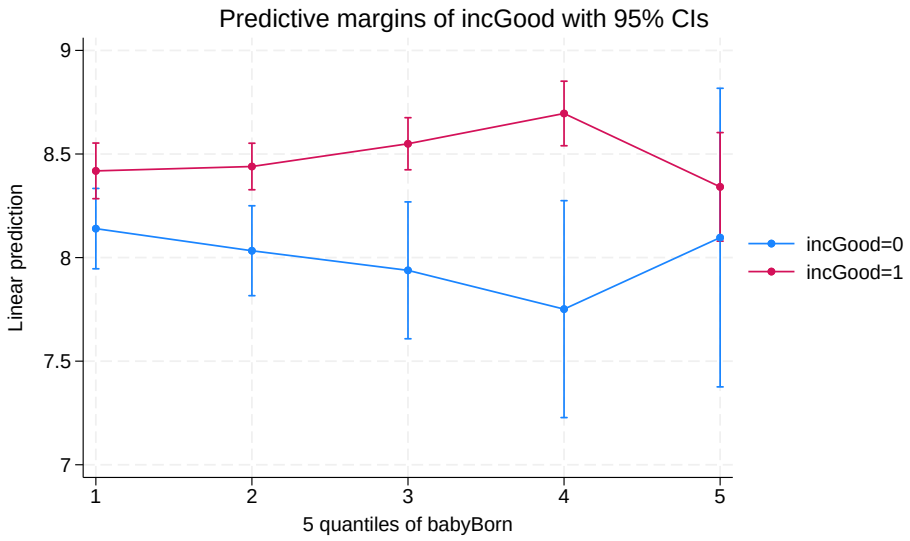


Figure 2: marginsplot

2.3 $< 2024 - 04 - 24 Wed >$ (first try; preliminary! need to do more thinking and double checking)

In table 7 in column a1 bivariate regression (incl year dummies as all do) having baby (dummy) improves happiness by .16. In a2 adding interaction with female shows that actually males happier with babies! Also visualized in figure 3. Interestingly for females the relationship is quite flat–not much increase in happiness if has baby–just from 8.2 to little less than 8.3. But for males increase is from little less than 8.2 to little more than 8.4. There was some literature I guess that mothers were actually less happy hanging out with babies than with friends (not sure about fathers).

Adding age and health in a3 doesnt change the interaction of baby with female. In a4 estrato decreases effect size of the interaction. Controlling for size of household in a5 doesnt change it.

But then in a6 security "You feel your neighborhood is safe?" actualy increases eeffect size on the interaction–security is something to explore further with respect to babies and females!!

Finally in a7 addition of income kills the significance on the interaction. Like security, income is something to explore with respect to babies, which I do in next table.

Table 7: OLS regressions of `life satisfaction`.

	a1	a2	a3	a4	a5	a6	a7
Tenencia de hijos	0.16***						
No		0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00
Si		0.26***	0.28***	0.31***	0.28***	0.33***	0.23**
female=0		0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00
female=1		0.04	0.12*	0.11+	0.09	0.18*	0.19**
No × female=0		0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00
No × female=1		0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00
Si × female=0		0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00
Si × female=1		-0.18*	-0.18*	-0.16+	-0.16+	-0.20*	-0.12
age			0.01	0.01	0.01	0.01	0.00
age squared			-0.00	-0.00	-0.00	-0.00	0.00
Health condition			0.32***	0.30***	0.31***	0.31***	0.29***
socio-economic strata=1				0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00
socio-economic strata=2				0.04	0.03	0.04	-0.03
socio-economic strata=3				0.10	0.11	0.04	-0.06
socio-economic strata=4				0.07	0.09	0.06	-0.11
socio-economic strata=5				0.35***	0.36***	0.32***	0.11
socio-economic strata=6				0.51***	0.51***	0.48***	0.20
household size=1					0.00	0.00	0.00
household size=2					0.34***	0.34**	0.34**
household size=3					0.27**	0.27*	0.31**
household size=4					0.32***	0.36***	0.42***
household size=5					0.38***	0.44***	0.49***
household size=6					0.25+	0.26+	0.31+
household size=7					0.48**	0.48*	0.52**
household size=8					0.36	0.40	0.48
household size=9					0.73*	0.62*	0.73*
household size=10					0.65+	0.65	0.73+
household size=11					-0.17	-0.40	-0.23
household size=12					0.99	0.34	0.37
household size=13					1.05+	1.15*	1.27***
household size=14					1.94***	2.09***	2.32***
household size=15					-6.25***	-6.48***	-6.67***
household size=16					1.12	2.76***	3.01***
household size=20					1.83***	1.60***	1.89***
household size=30					-0.74	-0.63	-0.48
household size=32					1.92***	2.05***	2.38***
household size=50					-1.12***	-0.97***	-1.03***
household size=105					2.61***	2.57***	2.61***
safe in city						0.32***	0.33***
no income							0.00
lt 1 SMMLV							0.05
1-2 SMMLV							0.36***
2-4 SMMLV							0.50***
4-8 SMMLV							0.61***
gt 8 SMMLV							0.81***
constant	8.36***	8.34***	6.96***	6.93***	6.59***	6.50***	6.59***
N	6568	6536	6489	6475	6472	5233	5146

+ 0.10 * 0.05 ** 0.01 *** 0.001

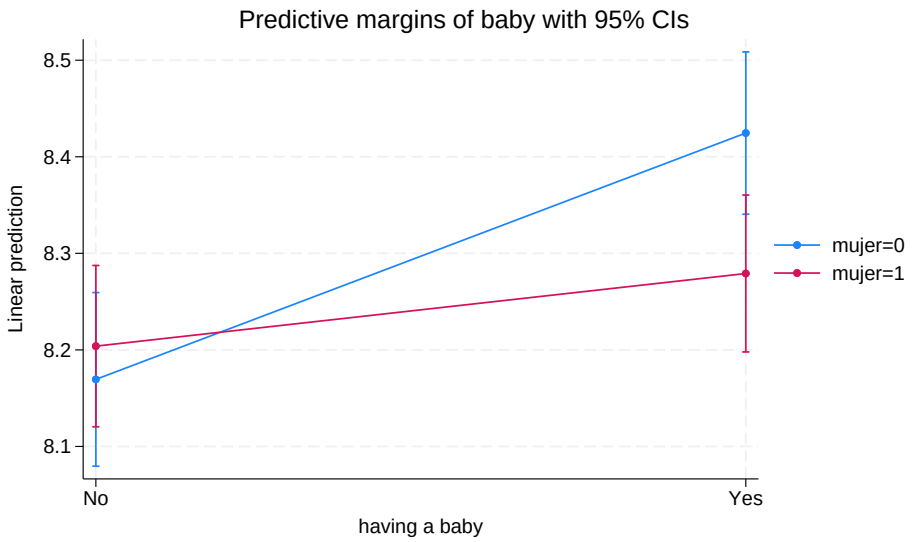


Figure 3: marginsplot

Results now in table 8. I generate a dummy for good income: 1 if income>1SMMLV
recode promedioingresos (0 1 =0)(2 3 4 5=1),gen(incGood)
and interact it with having a baby, and indeed as expected, having baby and good income is more happiness than having baby and bad income in column b1, also visualized in graph 4. With bad income (no income or less than 1 SMMLV)–there is no difference baby or no baby; but with good income, mmore than 1 SMMLV, having baby produces more happiness–also visualized in figure 4.

Table 8: OLS regressions of `life satisfaction`.

	b1	b2
No	0.00	0.00
Si	0.02	-0.13
RECODE of promedioingresos (income)=0	0.00	0.00
RECODE of promedioingresos (income)=1	0.25**	0.21+
No × RECODE of promedioingresos (income)=0	0.00	0.00
No × RECODE of promedioingresos (income)=1	0.00	0.00
Si × RECODE of promedioingresos (income)=0	0.00	0.00
Si × RECODE of promedioingresos (income)=1	0.23*	0.51**
female=0	0.00	0.00
female=1	0.12*	0.12
age	0.01	0.01
age squared	-0.00	-0.00
Health condition	0.29***	0.29***
socio-economic strata=1	0.00	0.00
socio-economic strata=2	-0.04	-0.03
socio-economic strata=3	-0.05	-0.06
socio-economic strata=4	-0.06	-0.07
socio-economic strata=5	0.19*	0.19*
socio-economic strata=6	0.34*	0.35*
household size=1	0.00	0.00
household size=2	0.33**	0.33**
household size=3	0.29**	0.28**
household size=4	0.39***	0.38***
household size=5	0.46***	0.46***
household size=6	0.29+	0.30+
household size=7	0.49*	0.48*
household size=8	0.47	0.47
household size=9	0.73*	0.73*
household size=10	0.73+	0.72+
household size=11	-0.22	-0.23
household size=12	0.34	0.34
household size=13	1.25***	1.37***
household size=14	2.36***	2.29***
household size=15	-6.79***	-6.71***
household size=16	3.09***	3.25***
household size=20	1.89***	1.81***
household size=30	-0.50	-0.46
household size=32	2.29***	2.29***
household size=50	-1.16***	-1.07***
household size=105	2.52***	2.51***
safe in city	0.33***	0.34***
2019	0.00	0.00
2021	-0.51***	-0.51***
2022	-0.30***	-0.30***
No × female=0		0.00
No × female=1		0.00
Si × female=0		0.00
Si × female=1		0.23
female=0 × RECODE of promedioingresos (income)=0		0.00
female=0 × RECODE of promedioingresos (income)=1		0.00
female=1 × RECODE of promedioingresos (income)=0		0.00
female=1 × RECODE of promedioingresos (income)=1		0.11
No × female=0 × RECODE of promedio-ingresos (income)=0		0.00
No × female=0 × RECODE of promedio-ingresos (income)=1		0.00
No × female=1 × RECODE of promedio-ingresos (income)=0		0.00
No × female=1 × RECODE of promedio-ingresos (income)=1		0.00
Si × female=0 × RECODE of promedio-ingresos (income)=0		0.00
Si × female=0 × RECODE of promedio-ingresos (income)=1		0.00
Si × female=1 × RECODE of promedio-ingresos (income)=0		0.00
Si × female=1 × RECODE of promedio-ingresos (income)=1		-0.49*
constant	6.64***	6.64***
N	5146	5146

+ 0.10 * 0.05 ** 0.01 *** 0.001

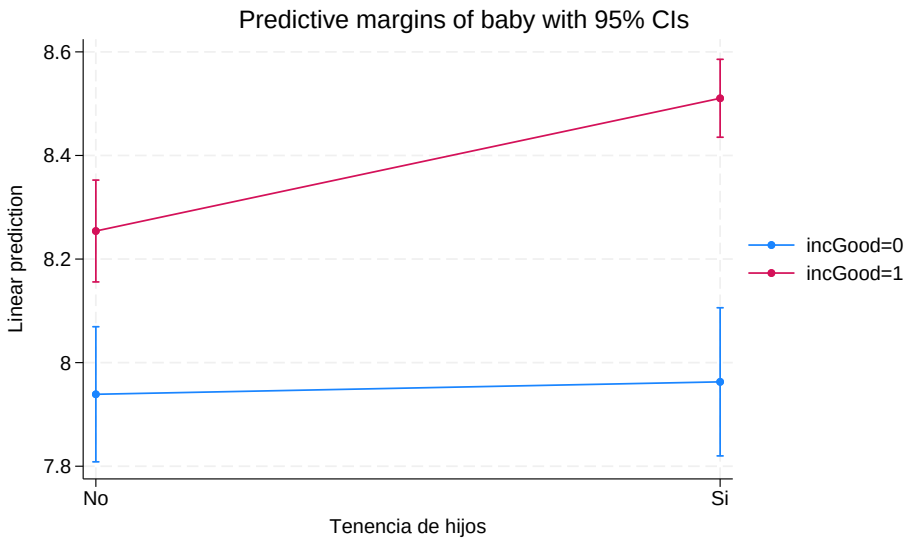


Figure 4: marginsplot

And then combining everything together in column b2: baby, female, and good income; also visualized in graph 5. This is now 3-way interaction and little cumbersome, but interesting. Not having babies (No on x-axis) all groups are closer to each other on the left than having babies on the right–babies magnify gender and income differentials. Starting with males with bad income (blue line): they are least happy with or without babies, but even less happy with babies. Males with good income (red) are in the middle on happiness without babies, but having babies they are the happiest of all–similar to females with good income (yellow line). And in the middle (green)–females with bad income, only slightly happier with babies.

Another interesting thing–females (green and yellow lines) improve only slightly having babies (the 2 slopes are parallel); but for males the story is very different and it depends on income and is magnified by babies. Males without babies only about .2 or so different in happiness based on income like 7.9 v 8.1 or so; but with babies the difference is about .8 on 1-10 happness scale, like 7.7 v 8.5. Big difference.

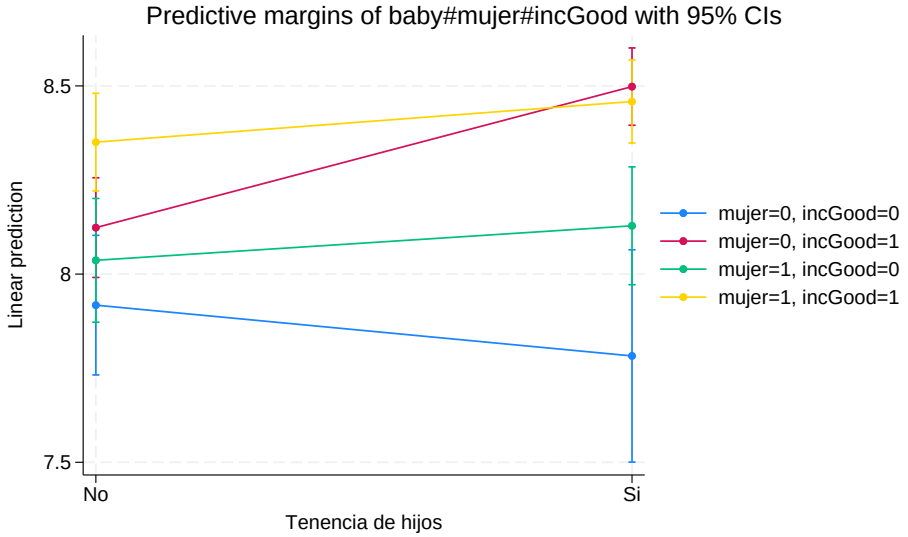


Figure 5: marginsplot